



Q What can I do now so that the first few weeks go as smoothly as possible?

There are plenty of practical ways in which you can prepare for the arrival of your baby (see below). By getting things in order now, you'll feel more at ease and ready for the first few weeks.

Get ahead of the game

With all eyes on the main event, it can be easy to overlook the more practical considerations of how you will manage once your baby has made his appearance. However, it's most definitely worth putting some preparation and thought in now so you can make life as easy as possible after the birth, when you will find that taking care of your new baby takes up a surprising amount of your time with little opportunity to deal with other matters.



ORGANIZE YOUR HOME LIFE

If you find yourself having sudden urges to clean the house, for example, go with it—it's all part of your nesting instinct. But don't forget to take some time for yourself now, too, and consider practical and emotional support from family and friends once your baby arrives.

Line up support

Many new parents find support and help from family and friends invaluable in the early weeks after the birth. You will probably be exhausted and interrupted nights can come as a bit of a shock. Anything that can lighten the load will be appreciated. If you expect twins, or you have a planned C-section, you will need additional help such as having a close relative to stay, using a maternity nurse or a doula. Discuss whether your partner can take time off.



Meet friends

Another important source of support after the birth will be other new parents—and a crucial mental boost at a time when you are adjusting to an entirely different routine. If you belong to a childbirth group, make sure you have contact details for the other mothers. Once your babies arrive, you will be very busy and it can be easier to stick to prearranged dates. Meeting up can help you feel connected and supported.



Rest & relax

It may not feel like getting organized for your baby's arrival, but taking a little time for a treat now can help you relax, increase your sense of well-being, and generally put you in a good place mentally and physically for your new baby. Whether it's lunch with friends, a relaxing pedicure or massage, or a movie date with your partner, make the most of your free time now. Schedule a little treat for yourself, especially if it's something that will require much more organizing after the birth.

